

About Hud



Hud (Seidu) Daannaa

Manager - Sr Security Architect (R&D) - Lead (Big Data & SOC Specialist) - Lecturer - MSc| CEH| AWS-SAA| AZ-500| GCHQ| EC-Council-CS-Career-Mentor

With over a **decade** of experience in cybersecurity, **Hud specializes** in building cutting-edge security tools and secure architectures. Recently, He developed a **state-of-the-art threat intelligence SaaS platform leveraging AI technologies**. As an experienced Security Architect, He led and **managed the development of advanced Next Generation SOC's for the private and government sectors**, all with **top-level security clearance**, ensuring robust defence mechanisms and operational excellence. His **leadership** extends to engaging clients in comprehensive knowledge transfer and training sessions, empowering them with the latest in cybersecurity practices. Additionally, Hud has a strong track record of over **8 years in the open-source community**, where he authored influential libraries and articles, driving innovation and knowledge sharing. Hud is also a **part-time lecturer and a mentor**, where he is dedicated to passing on his expertise to the next generation of cybersecurity professionals.

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PROJECTS SUMMARY

Find below repositories to my project (these are a selected few) highlighting

Employment Experience

As a **Senior security and engineer and architect**, I hold a **managerial** position at **Maguire LLC**, based in Dubai. Operating with the highest level of security clearance in the country, I led the design, architecture and engineering of multiple **next generation security operation centres(SOCs)** on the **nation level**, for government entities across the UAE I have designed and built security tools, created modules connectors and integrations to build custom solutions depending on some use-case. I have also developed training materials to train clients. Successfully delivering projects and being awarded the UAE golden visa for special talent, I also mentored and influenced the careers of my team mates, to which I am proud of.

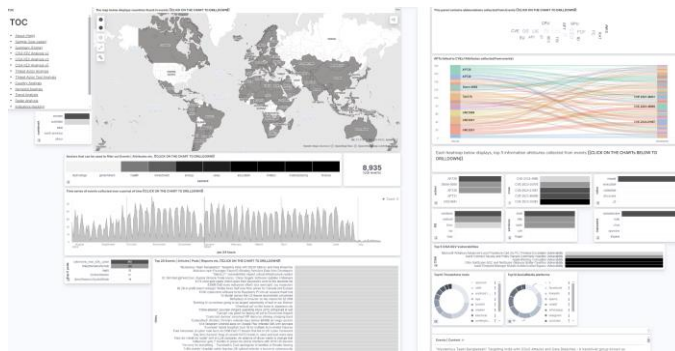
Project	Designed and Built an Attack Surface Management (ASM) System to automate vulnerability scan and analysis and penetration test simulation .
Technologies	Tenable SC, Nessus, Rapid7 Metasploit Pro, Rapid7 App Spider, Nmap, PostgreSQL, Mongo DB, Python, Flask, API, Tableau, MySQL, SOAR, Ansible
Description	<i>Designed and led the creation of an ASM system to automate vulnerability scans and simulate penetration tests, improving security posture and response time.</i>
Reference	https://github.com/huddaannaa/ASM-Transactor/blob/main/ASM-Transactor-doc.pdf
Project	Designed and implemented a for the Integration of an Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) System into an existing environment.
Technologies	Nutanix, VMware ESXi, Endgame EDR, Python, EQL, SCCM
Description	<i>Led the integration of EDR into the current infrastructure to enhance endpoint security, providing automated threat detection and response capabilities.</i>
Reference	
Project	Developed a Big Data Packet Inspection System with analytics
Technologies	Hadoop, Apache Kafka, Zookeeper Apache Storm, Zeek IDS, HDFS, Elastic, Kibana, Ansible
Description	<i>Designed and implemented a system for real-time packet inspection and analytics, leveraging big data technologies for enhanced network security.</i>
Reference	
Project	Designed, Developed, and Managed a Security Data-lake using HADOOP
Technologies	SOAR (Simplify), EDR (Endgame), Beats, CTI, ELK, Apache Kafka, Zookeeper Jupiter notebook, Memcached, MongoDB, Python, Apache Spark, docker (swarm, compose), AZURE, AWS
Description	<i>Created and managed a security data-lake for comprehensive threat intelligence and incident response, utilizing big data technologies for scalable security solutions.</i>
Reference	https://cwiki.apache.org/confluence/display/METRON/Metron+Architecture https://github.com/huddaannaa/NextGenSOC-Snippet/tree/main/2-SOC
Project	Designed, Developed, and Managed a Security Data-lake using Elastic stack and Beats tools
Technologies	Elastic SIEM, Fleet server, Apache Kafka, Zookeeper Jupiter notebook, Python, Apache Spark, Kubernetes, G42(Huawei cloud), Open CTI
Description	<i>Developed a security data-lake using Elastic Stack, enhancing data collection, processing, and threat detection capabilities.</i>
Reference	https://github.com/huddaannaa/Fleet-Style-Security-Data-Lake

Project	Designed, Developed, and Managed a Next-Generation SOC in an Air-Gapped Environment
Technologies	AWS, Azure, Hadoop, Apache (Kafka, Zookeeper, yarn, Storm, HDFS) HBase, CrowdStrike intelligence, MISP, CRITS, Zeek IDS, Elastic, Kibana, Ansible
Description	<i>Created a secure, isolated SOC leveraging advanced technologies for comprehensive threat detection and incident response.</i>
Reference	https://github.com/huddaannaa/NextGenSOC-Snippet/tree/main/1-SOC
Project	Designed, Developed, and Managed a Next-Generation SOC online
Technologies	AWS, Azure, Hadoop, Apache (Kafka, Zookeeper, yarn, Storm, HDFS) HBase, CrowdStrike intelligence, MISP, CRITS, Zeek IDS, Elastic, Kibana, Ansible
Description	<i>Developed an online SOC integrating various security tools and big data technologies for enhanced threat monitoring and response.</i>
Reference	https://github.com/huddaannaa/NextGenSOC-Snippet/tree/main/2-SOC
Project	Researching, Designing and Implementing by upgrading an existing SOC with an Artificial Intelligence Program
Technologies	Nvidia tesla H100 GPU, LLMs (llama2,3, GPT-4o), chatbots, Langchain, vector databases (Chroma, Qdrand, Elasticsearch), AI Agents, Meta-Prompting, Prompt engineering, NLTK, Spacy, Google collab
Description	<i>Leveraging GPT models to enhance SOC alert investigation, automate routine tasks, and improve threat detection and incident response.</i>
Reference	

Data source Experience: McAfee EPO AV, Endpoint protector (EPP), Endgame EDR, CrowdStrike EDR, CrowdStrike intelligence, Bluecoat proxy, Cisco IOS, Cisco ISE, panorama firewall, SonicWall firewall, F5 load balancer, ASM f5, Symantec Email Gateway, Forti mail, Forti SOAR, Windows, Active Directory, Exchange, Forescout, Vcenter, ESXI, Privilege Access Management(PAM), Infoblox, Imperva, Tenable Nessus, Metasploit

TechVibe | Techsphere (SIFIA)

Security Intelligence Feed and Indicator Analytics (SIFIA)



I founded Techsphere as a startup with a focus on innovative cybersecurity solutions. One of our flagship products is **Security Intelligence Feed and Indicator Analytics (SIFIA)**, which **originated from my home lab** and is now undergoing Proof of Concept (POC) evaluations with several clients in production environments. SIFIA is a **cyber threat intelligence big data (unique), SaaS multi-cloud and hybrid platform designed to operate within a zero-trust environment**. I personally designed, developed, and implemented this solution from the ground up. **SIFIA** collects and ingests OSINT data, dark web content, security news articles, and other threat-related feeds from verified, credible, and paid sources globally. **Utilizing large language models (LLMs)** and advanced data processing techniques, the data undergoes extensive preparation, processing, and filtration. This process extracts vital information in the form of Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) through data correlation and enrichment methodologies.

Technologies: AWS, Digital Ocean cloud, Cloudflare, VMware ESXI, python, bash, Flask, ELK, Beats Apache Spark, Apache Kafka, MongoDB, Llama3, GPT, APIs, HDFS, Docker (swarm, compose), Dashboards, Vega, chatbots, Langchain, vector databases (Chroma, Qdrant, Elasticsearch), AI Agents, Meta-Prompting, Prompt engineering, NLTK, Spacy

The architecture is a **cyber threat intelligence big data echo system (unique)**, which **ingest data** from **multiple sources** (OSINT, dark web data, articles, **audio** etc.), processes and indexes the data:

1. It applies AI algorithms to analyse and auto generate reports and insights to help boost **GRC, threat hunting teams, vulnerability management, risk analysis, tailored for CISOs, threat hunters and analysts** in general.
2. The solution has an **API** for data streaming and serves as cyber threat intelligence (**CTI**) to tools like **SIEM, SOAR** etc.
3. It has a **chatbot** that leverages **LLM** and **RAG** technologies to interact with data collected into the ecosystem.

Below are the resources to the solution:

1. **Website:** <https://www.techsphere.biz/>
2. The **preview** of the **product** (old version/new version available): <https://www.techsphere.biz/productpreview>
3. **Presentation document:** <https://onedrive.live.com/view.aspx?resid=BC6C1638DFED86AA%217325&authkey=!AJeR8nODwy4asnA>
4. **Administrative guide:** <https://onedrive.live.com/?authkey=%21AE0271%2DxzTWctfE&id=BC6C1638DFED86AA%217319&cid=BC6C1638DFED86AA&parId=root&parQt=sharedby&o=OneUp>
5. **Demo:** trail (contacting me will be required): <https://fs-ui.trendsetterfarm.com/>
6. **API documentation:** <https://github.com/huddaannaa/SIFIA-TechVibe-TechSphere.md/blob/main/API-Overview.md>

Repository For Projects & Opensource Contributions



Experience

Articles

Voluntary
experience

Projects

LinkedIn contains work on some **projects, voluntary experience, articles, recommendations**, etc. I worked on: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/hud-daannaa-senior-security-engineer/>

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/hud-daannaa-senior-security-engineer/details/experience/>

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/hud-daannaa-senior-security-engineer/recent-activity/articles/>

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/hud-daannaa-senior-security-engineer/details/volunteering-experiences/>

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/hud-daannaa-senior-security-engineer/details/projects/>



Articles

Blogger contains some **articles** and **capture the flag walkthroughs**:

<https://www.blogger.com/profile/17709584165773234732>

<https://articles-by-hud.blogspot.com/>

<https://huddaannaa.blogspot.com/>



Lectures

Project

GitHub contains some of my **works** (project, documentations/code sample) and **lecture** notes: **Repositories**:

<https://github.com/huddaannaa>?tab=repositories

DFIR: <https://github.com/huddaannaa/DFIR>

PrivacySearchEngine: <https://github.com/huddaannaa/PrivacySearchEngine>

NextGenSOC-Snippet: <https://github.com/huddaannaa/NextGenSOC-Snippet>

ASM-Transactor: <https://github.com/huddaannaa/ASM-Transactor/blob/main/ASM-Transactor-doc.pdf>

Hud-s-Password-Manager-CLI-v.1.0: <https://github.com/huddaannaa/Hud-s-Password-Manager-CLI-v.1.0>

Intelligence-notes-tool: <https://github.com/huddaannaa/Intelligence-notes-tool>

HudsLogSanitizer: <https://github.com/huddaannaa/HudsLogSanitizer>

risk assessment: <https://github.com/huddaannaa/RiskAssessmentUsingNIST>

Falcon-Crowdstrike-intel-2-Crits-shipper:

<https://github.com/huddaannaa/Falcon-Crowdstrike-intel-2-Crits-shipper>

Secure-File-Transfer-App: <https://github.com/huddaannaa/Secure-File-Transfer-App>



Packages

Contributions to give back to the community, by collaborating with other developers to ensure the reliability and usability of the packages:

<https://pypi.org/user/hudkdaannaa/>

<https://pypi.org/project/hudutils/0.7/>

Autobiography of **Hud Seidu Daannaa**

Introduction

My name is **Hud Seidu Daannaa**, and I am a dedicated learner, artist, and inventor in the field of cybersecurity. Over the past decade, I have had the privilege to immerse myself in the dynamic world of cybersecurity, **building cutting-edge security tools and secure architectures**. Recently, I developed a state-of-the-art threat intelligence SaaS platform leveraging AI technologies. As an experienced **Security Architect**, I have led and managed the development of advanced **Next Generation SOC**s for both private and government sectors, achieving top-level security clearance and ensuring robust defence mechanisms and operational excellence. My journey also includes **engaging clients in comprehensive knowledge transfer and training sessions**, empowering them with the latest in cybersecurity practices. Additionally, I have **contributed to the country's cybersecurity strategy**, enhancing national security posture and resilience against emerging threats. My approach is always **empathetic and user-focused**, ensuring that my strategies consider business needs and employee experience.

Early Curiosity and Learning

From a young age, I have been fascinated by taking things apart and putting them back together. This curiosity led me to assemble computers, build networks, and master operating systems like Windows and Linux. My quest for deeper understanding propelled me into learning Bash and Batch scripting, and eventually, I ventured into **ethical hacking**. It was here that I discovered my passion for coding and began developing custom payloads and tools. With this foundation, I pursued and completed my **master's degree in cybersecurity**, where my thesis focused on data science and cybersecurity, culminating in the creation of an **Intrusion Detection System (IDS) based on natural laws**.

Professional Milestones

Midway through my career, I assumed a lead role in **attack surface management**, designing a system to track vulnerabilities, and developing a custom module for validating vulnerabilities. I integrated these with SIEM for advanced correlation. In my subsequent role, I built **security data lake (SIEM) solutions** by leveraging custom and open-source components. My ethical hacking expertise allowed me to design and develop **advanced threat detection use cases**. Throughout these roles, I **used data-driven approaches** to inform security decisions and ensure effective risk management.

Mastery and Leadership

Over time, I mastered various security tools in the respective cybersecurity domains by understanding how they were built, their functionalities, and how they interconnect. This expertise led to my role as a **SOC Architect**, where I attained the highest level of security clearance in the country. In this role, I led my team to complete **five SOC projects**, meet business needs, and was honoured to be awarded the **UAE Golden Visa for exceptional talent**. My contributions have significantly impacted the national cybersecurity strategy, ensuring robust defence mechanisms and operational excellence across various sectors.

Continuous Exploration and Teaching

My passion for exploration remains undiminished. I have developed a **threat intelligence solution**, leveraging the power of large language models. What started as a hobby is now undergoing trials for production. Additionally, I was honoured to be appointed as a part-time lecturer at the **University of Middlesex Dubai**, where I teach both undergraduate and graduate students. Teaching is one of the many ways I aim to give back to the community and leave a legacy. One of my greatest achievements is **growing and mentoring a team**, where I am looked up to as an example.

Philosophy and Approach

Crafting solutions to challenging problems in a manner consistent with organizational goals has been a cornerstone of my career. My abilities span areas such as **Big Data, Integrations, Cyber Security Engineering & Threat Analytics, Penetration Testing, Software Development, Data Science**, and **Cloud Computing**. I draw solutions to troubleshooting issues and consider my

work as art, seeing artistry in everything. Knowledge is endless like the ocean, and I believe one can learn and draw solutions from the most basic things. This mindset makes me a strong and supportive team player and an addict to my art.

Vision for the *Future*

My vision for the future is to continue **inventing secure architectures by thinking out of the box**, creating solutions that not only enhance cybersecurity but also have a profound impact on humanity. **The ability to spread positivity and empower one's surroundings is key. To be revered as a beacon of hope, and a mentor to the next generation "A LEGACY" that will be echoed even after one's demise is priceless... "Amongst all my dreams, this is my greatest."**

"For all the knowledge, I've acquired in my lifetime, I wish to pass on and still live on."

With this vision, I aim to design innovative security frameworks that can adapt to the ever-evolving threat landscape, ensuring robust protection for organizations worldwide. My goal is to **create a lasting impact on the cybersecurity field**, fostering a culture of continuous learning and improvement, and mentoring the next generation of cybersecurity professionals to carry forward the torch of excellence and innovation.

Conclusion

I owe my achievements to the teams that supported me throughout the years. My journey in cybersecurity is like the latitude running through different areas of the earth, evolving from repairing computers, developing software, designing security architectures, building custom tools, and integrating security solutions to achieve security goals. I am eager to bring my unique skills and experiences to your team and look forward to discussing my candidacy further.